# Center for Ethical Intelligence — Business Plan 2027–2029

Oct 31, 2026 · @Jimmy

**AI will be aligned to something. We exist to help it reflect wisdom.** The Center for Ethical Intelligence (CEI) builds open, pluralistic moral infrastructure — datasets, benchmarks and evaluation tools — that shape how AI systems are trained and judged. This plan is for prospective board members and funders.

## Executive summary

**AI will be aligned to something, and today which values the most powerful models are trained toward is decided mostly inside a few companies. The Center for Ethical Intelligence (CEI) translates the world's moral traditions, religious and secular, into open benchmarks and evaluations that test how faithfully models represent those traditions and whether they act on the values they state. We are a research organization: our success is rigorous, open, published work; use by labs and auditors is influence we track, not the bar we are judged by.**

**The problem.** AI now makes consequential decisions in medicine, law, finance and education, yet the values it is trained toward are set inside a handful of companies. Anthropic co-founder Chris Olah has asked publicly for "moral voices that the incentives cannot bend" (remarks at the Vatican, May 2026). There is no shared, trusted way to measure how well a model reasons about moral questions — or whose moral wisdom it reflects. Labs, buyers and regulators have no independent, open test of how AI reasons about right and wrong across the world's moral traditions; CEI builds the methods for that test, and works with each tradition to apply them.

**What we build.** CEI develops open, pluralistic methods for translating moral wisdom into benchmarks, metrics and evaluations — and then partners with scholars and communities from many moral traditions to apply them to their own tradition. The resulting tests show how AI models represent and apply each tradition, how soundly they reason, and whether they act on the values they state. We never crown one tradition's answer as "correct."

**Three programs. AI Alignment**, our flagship, builds the benchmarks. **AI Governance** maintains a database of AI-governance documents behind our Governance Symphony study. The **Scholar Group** convenes scholars across disciplines and moral traditions for sustained academic work on values alignment and how moral traditions bear on it.

**Our niche.** Much AI-safety work asks whether models can be made to reliably follow the values they are given, and how to control them if not. CEI works on a complementary question: the *target* of alignment — which values, as understood by the traditions that hold them, and whether models represent and act on them faithfully. Unlike most groups working on values, we do this technically, alongside computer scientists, turning principles into usable benchmarks, datasets and evaluations.

**Who we are.** CEI has two founders, both part-time volunteers and unpaid in every year of this plan: Jimmy Lin, MD, PhD, MHS, MA (Religion), Co-Founder and President, Chief Scientific Officer at Freenome; and Rui Guo, LLM, SJD, Co-Founder and Research Director, a legal scholar of AI ethics. About 40 volunteer researchers contribute as individuals. CEI was founded by Christians who believe every person bears the image of God. That conviction is why we build a fair table where every tradition speaks for itself, rather than a tool for one community. Our role is to be a bridge between the AI research community and communities of moral wisdom: rigorous by the standards of AI research, and faithful to each tradition by its own.

**Proof so far (2024–26, all volunteer, about $7K awarded).**

- **Governance Symphony:** 5,140 AI-governance statements from 130 countries, about 2,700 of them coded so far. The early finding: solidarity and religious-pastoral principles appear only when faith, labor and Indigenous sources are included, so whose voice is in the data changes the result.
- **Research assets:** a 2,368-entry catalog of moral benchmarks and datasets, a 5,140-statement AI-governance corpus, and 7,041 professional ethics codes from 661 organizations (licensing not yet reviewed).
- **Early relationships:** a rapid-response sub-award through Faith Work & Tech's Notre Dame DELTA grant; selection for Praxis's 2027 Nonprofit Accelerator; co-authors at Harvard and Notre Dame.

**The plan.** Publish benchmark v1 within 12 months of the first paid hire. Tranche 1 guarantees the **v1 core**: two modules, one secular and one faith, plus the say–do pilot (does a model act on a stated value when acting costs it its goal?) and the sycophancy probe. Tranche 2 adds the other two modules and the public release: the **full v1** of four benchmarks, each built on a different source of moral wisdom (normative ethics; moral psychology, exploratory in v1; the UN Universal Declaration of Human Rights; and Pope Leo XIV's encyclical *Magnifica humanitas*, in v1; CEI's draft is a pilot until the Catholic panel we are recruiting rewrites and ratifies it). A fifth module authored by an outside community and a local-run kit are stretch goals. Results are per-model profile reports with

no composite score, badge or certification, published independently, including unfavorable ones. Alongside the research: seat a board of seven to nine directors with an independent majority, and make the first paid hires in a fixed order.

**What success means.** Success is publishing the method and v1 on schedule, with its validation statistics, so that anyone can inspect and use them. Outside use is the influence we hope follows; we track it, and one stop rule binds us: if no one outside CEI has run the suite within 18 months of v1's release, the board will not fund a second version on the same distribution model.

**The ask.** About **$308K for 2027**, raised in two tranches:

1. **First, about $212K** — a part-time contract research engineer (about 500 hours), engaged first; then a technical co-lead; then a fractional Executive Director (about 60% time, employed through our fiscal sponsor) once nine months of the role's loaded cost has been received; plus the AI compute and infrastructure to build and run the benchmarks, and legal, insurance and accounting (unlocks a seated board, a working evaluation harness and the v1 core).
2. **Then, about $96K** — a research fellow from mid-year, expert annotation and tradition leads, and a first Scholar Group convening (unlocks the two further modules and the public release of benchmark v1).

Nothing is committed for 2027; about $7K has been awarded to date and not yet received. The $308K ask is the Aggressive path; our identified pipeline today supports the Conservative one. The founding circle we are asking to form by Mar 31, 2027 is three to five people giving $10K or more, mostly unrestricted. We are also inviting **a chair and a founding cohort of three to five independent directors** who will give, open doors and hold us to these outcomes.

## Mission, vision and values

*Draft for board adoption.*

**Mission.** CEI translates the world's moral wisdom into open methods, benchmarks and evaluations, so that the values AI is built toward are shaped in the open by the communities who hold them.

**Vision.** AI that serves human flourishing and dignity, whose values are shaped in the open and accountable to the communities that hold them, rather than decided by a few.

**Our story in one line.** AI will be aligned to something; we help make sure that something reflects wisdom, measured in the open.

**Values** (how we work)

- **Truthfulness:** we report setbacks alongside progress, and say plainly what our measures cannot show.
- **Openness:** methods, data and results are public by default.
- **A fair table:** each tradition speaks for itself, and no one controls the scoring.
- **Rigor:** pre-registered methods, peer review and outside scrutiny.
- **Stewardship:** we hold this work in trust for others, and build an institution that outlasts its founders.

**Principles that hold however fast AI changes** (what we believe about AI)

1. AI should serve persons, never the reverse; every person has dignity.
2. Moral wisdom is plural, and those who hold a tradition should define it.
3. Measurement serves human judgment; it never replaces it.
4. Those who evaluate AI must be independent of those they evaluate.
5. What we test should be what matters: action, not just eloquent talk.
6. Values work should be open enough that any community can check it for itself.

Why a Christian-founded organization builds a table for every tradition, and the standard we ask readers to hold us to, is in Appendix E.

## The opportunity

AI capability is outrunning our ability to say — and test — what it should value. That gap is now the field's central problem, and it is wide open for an independent, trusted builder.

**Capability is accelerating.** In four years AI went from failing grade-school arithmetic to Olympiad-level math, and from autocompleting code to writing much of it at leading labs. AI agents now act in the world, which raises the stakes of what they value and how they decide.

**Someone must choose the target — and the question is *which values*.** Even if alignment techniques succeed, someone must decide what models should be aligned to. Today those choices are made privately by a few companies and are rarely tested in public. Pope Leo XIV's encyclical *Magnifica humanitas* warns that "a more moral AI is not enough if that morality is determined by a few."

**The missing piece is open, rigorous measurement.** Models behave according to what they are trained on and measured against. Today:

- Value specifications — model specs and constitutions — are written inside a few companies and checked mostly by those same companies.
- Public moral benchmarks exist but are scattered, mostly Western, and rarely authored by the communities whose values they claim to test.
- Most groups working on values stay at the level of principles and lack the technical capacity to turn them into tests.
- Few tests check whether models *act* on the values they state, rather than simply talk about them well.

**Why now.** Regulation (EU AI Act obligations phasing in from 2025 to 2027), a frontier lab's public call for outside critics, and a wave of new funding for human-centered AI (for example, the $500M Humanity AI coalition and Lilly's $50.8M DELTA grant at Notre Dame) mean the next two years will set the norms. Whoever builds trusted, open measurement tools in that window helps decide what "aligned" means.

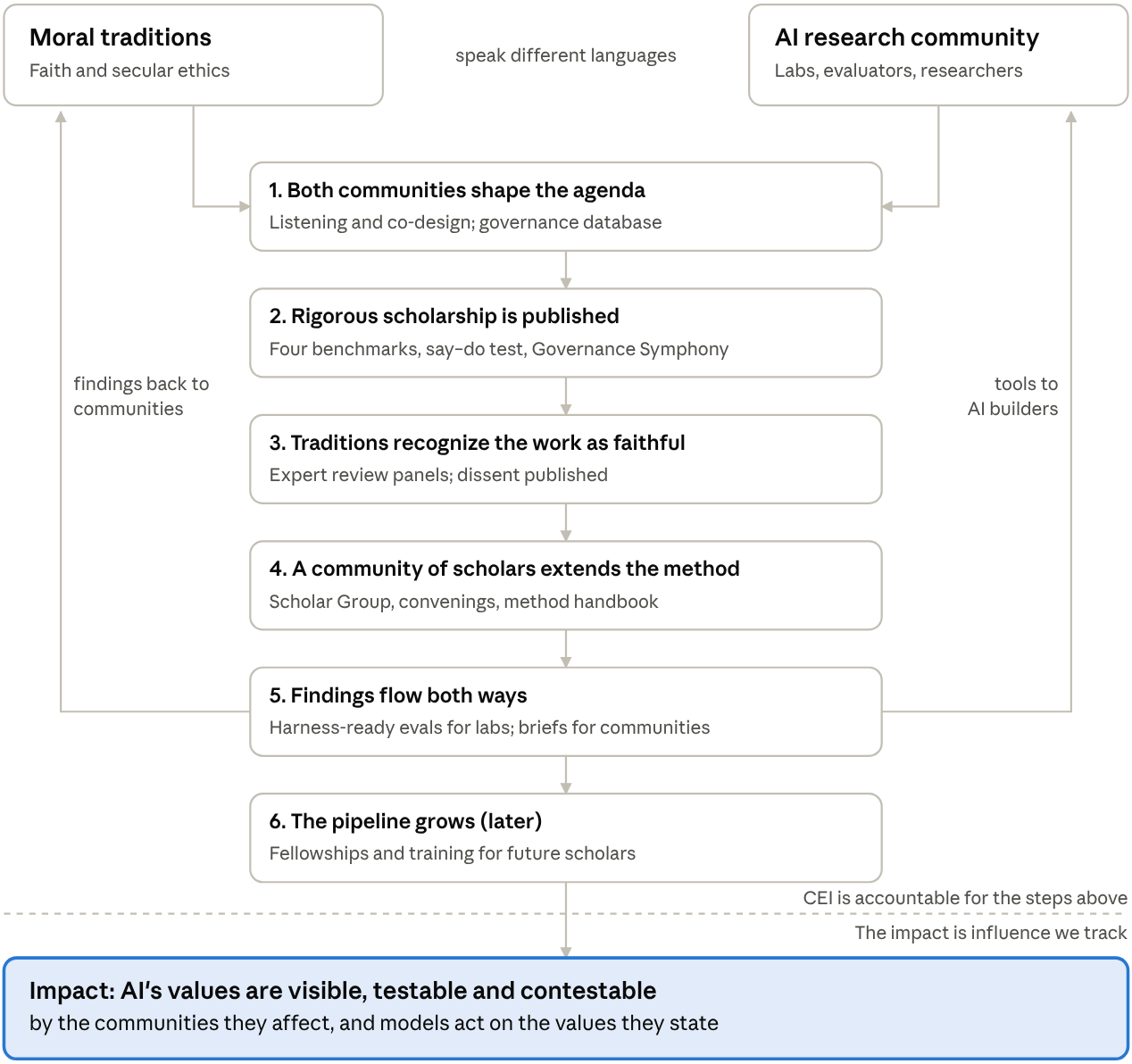
## Our solution and theory of change

Our theory of change is a bridge. The AI research community and the world's moral traditions speak different languages; CEI connects them with rigorous scholarship that both sides can trust, so that the values AI is built toward are shaped in the open by the communities who hold them.

**The gap.** Which values AI systems are aligned to is decided mostly inside labs. Their value specifications and evaluations draw little on the moral traditions, religious and secular, that most people live by, and rarely test whether models act on the values they state. Part of the barrier is language: traditions hold moral knowledge in texts, practices and reasoning, while AI research needs operational, testable specifications. Few people or methods connect the two credibly, in either direction.

**Our role: a bridge built by listening to both sides.** CEI aims to be rigorous by the standards of AI research and faithful to each tradition by its own standards. That is why our president is trained in both science and theology (MD, PhD, and an MA in religion); why we aim to publish at top AI venues; why we convene a multidisciplinary Scholar Group; and why we build a governance database of what societies say they want from AI. The bridge is proven only when both sides use it: each tradition's scholars ratify our reference points and recognize their module as faithful, and AI researchers run our tests.

**CEI bridges AI research and moral traditions, in both directions**




CEI theory of change · 6 steps, a two-way bridge

**In one sentence. If** CEI produces rigorous, peer-reviewed scholarship and open benchmarks, built with a documented method that is co-designed with moral traditions and validated by AI-research standards, and equips scholars and communities to extend it, **then** researchers, evaluators and labs will have credible evidence about which values models hold and whether they act on them, and faith and ethics communities will be able to shape that evidence themselves, **because** peer review and recognition by each tradition's own scholars earn trust, and evaluations that are cheap, automated and already in the harnesses labs and safety institutes use are the ones that get run.

## The pathway

| Outcome | What CEI does | How we will know |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Both communities shape the agenda** | Structured consultations with tradition scholars and with lab and evaluation researchers; the governance database maps the values societies and governments say they want AI to hold | Sources in co-design (two in the v1 core, four in the full v1, including secular frameworks); requirements gathered from at least three lab or evaluation researchers |
| **2. Rigorous scholarship is published** | We do the research ourselves: the four benchmarks, the say–do test and Governance Symphony, submitted to top AI venues (NeurIPS, ICLR, FAccT, AIES) and to ethics and theology venues | Papers accepted; validity results reported (rater agreement, robustness) |
| **3. Traditions recognize the work as faithful** | An expert review panel for each module; dissent published alongside results | Share of reference points ratified by the partner panel, and the dissent rate, per module; named scholars credited on each module, with institutions hosting modules, not certifying them |
| **4. A community of scholars extends the method** | The Scholar Group, convenings and a written method handbook | Modules or papers authored outside CEI; returning Scholar Group members |
| **5. Findings flow both ways** | Tests released in standard evaluation harnesses (Inspect, lm-evaluation-harness) for labs; plain-language briefs that explain alignment and our results to communities | Harness integrations and outside runs; briefings delivered and requested |

| Outcome | What CEI does | How we will know |
|---|---|---|
| **6. The pipeline grows** (later) | Fellowships and training for future scholars fluent in both worlds | Fellows funded and placed |

**Why this order.** Scholarship comes first because credibility comes first. Listening and co-design run alongside it, and the Scholar Group is being formed. Fellowships follow once the method is proven and funded.

## Partners and what each contributes

| Partner | Relationship today | What it contributes |
|---|---|---|
| Harvard and Notre Dame | In discussion with a program at Harvard Law School and an ethics institute at Notre Dame; co-authors on the Governance Symphony poster at both, and Toby Jia-Jun Li, a co-author, works closely with us | Academic review and co-authorship; reach in AI-governance and policy circles; faith-and-AI scholarship and convening |
| Notre Dame DELTA Network | Connected to the network through a rapid-response sub-award from Faith Work & Tech's DELTA grant | A route to Lilly-funded faith-and-AI work, fellowships and partner grants |
| Praxis | 2027 Nonprofit Accelerator fellow | Organizational and leadership formation; a network of mentors and funders |
| Faith-and-AI network | Working contacts at one frontier lab, which knows we will publish results it may dislike; contacts with Brian Patrick Green (Markkula Center, Santa Clara), Charles Camosy and AI and Faith | What a frontier lab needs from outside tests; introductions to theologians, including Catholic reviewers for the *Magnifica humanitas* module |

| Partner | Relationship today | What it contributes |
|---|---|---|
| AllFaith benchmark consortium (CEFE-AI: BYU, Baylor, Notre Dame, Yeshiva) | Partnership intended; we will open the conversation once v1 results exist | Reach into Jewish and other traditions; shared datasets and methods rather than rival benchmarks |
| **Partners we still need** | | An AI evaluation organization (harness integration and a pre-release pilot), Catholic theologians to write and review the encyclical module, and non-Christian and secular community partners (our strongest ties today are Protestant) |

## Key assumptions we will test

| Assumption | How we test it | What would make us stop |
|---|---|---|
| **Validity:** model answers reflect stable value dispositions, not prompt artifacts | Stability of each measure across paraphrases, formats and option order, reported separately from the say–do gap | A dimension whose scores move more with wording than between models is not reported; a module that fails this after two revisions is withdrawn |
| **Legitimacy:** our reviewers can speak for their traditions well enough | Ratification and dissent rates; inclusion criteria set by the methods committee | A module whose panel ratifies fewer than 80% of its reference points is not released; a partner's withdrawal freezes and labels its module |
| **Demand:** evaluators and researchers will run pluralistic values tests if they are easy to run | A pilot with one evaluation organization before release | No one outside CEI has run the suite within 18 months of v1's release: no second version on the same distribution model |

| Assumption | How we test it | What would make us stop |
|---|---|---|
| **Credibility:** peer review and respected partners lead to use | Citations and outside runs 12 months after publication | No citations and no outside runs 12 months after publication: the board reviews how we reach users before funding new modules |
| **Trust across traditions:** a Christian-founded CEI is trusted beyond Christian communities | Non-Christian and secular participation and retention | No non-Christian partner has agreed to author a module by the end of 2028: we say so publicly and stop describing many traditions as our state |
| **Capacity:** we can maintain what we publish | A maintenance plan and cost per module | A module we cannot keep current is retired and labeled, not left stale |
| **Independence:** publishing unfavorable results keeps lab access rather than losing it | Lab access and responses tracked after each embargoed release | Losing access after an unfavorable result changes nothing we publish; a funder that asks for review rights is declined |
| **Distinctiveness:** CEI adds what other faith benchmarks lack | Side-by-side comparison with AllFaith, Gloo and FaithfulBench in each paper; a partnership approach to AllFaith | A peer publishes an equivalent scholar-authored module first: we offer our method as its measurement layer rather than build a rival |
| **Discriminant validity:** the four modules measure different things | Between-module correlations and correlation with a generic ethics score reported; profiles that move together are reported as one measure | A dimension whose correlation with capability exceeds the pre-registered threshold (proposed 0.7) is reported as tracking capability, not values |

**What the evidence says (October 2026).** Labs want dialogue, not tests; the field of faith benchmarks is crowding; and the weakest link is whether model answers reflect stable values. Appendix C has the dated evidence check.

**What we are accountable for.** CEI answers for the six steps above. We publish independent scores that labs may or may not adopt, and we publish poor results too, including for labs we work with.

## Three programs, one flagship

| Program | What it does | Status today | Role in 2027 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **AI Alignment** (flagship) | Builds open benchmarks, datasets and evaluations that test how models represent and act on moral wisdom | Four benchmark prototypes; task specifications drafted; no scored outputs or human ratings yet | Publish benchmark v1 within 12 months of the first paid hire: the v1 core (two modules plus the say–do pilot and the sycophancy probe) on Tranche 1, the full v1 on Tranche 2 |
| **AI Governance** | Maintains a database of AI-governance documents and runs the Governance Symphony study of how the world's AI principles cluster | 5,140 statements mapped; full paper in preparation for AIES or NeurIPS 2027 | Continues with its volunteer team; human validation of the coding in 2027; supplies the governance and human-rights lens to the benchmarks |
| **Scholar Group** | Convenes scholars across disciplines and moral traditions for deep, multidisciplinary discussion of values alignment and how moral traditions bear on it | A database of about 650 prospective members compiled from public sources; no one contacted yet | In 2027, contact the roughly 20 scholars the v1 panels need; supplies module authors, expert raters, methods-committee members and co-authors; broader outreach and the first convening wait for Tranche 2 |

**One program leads, and the other two cost little in 2027.** AI Governance carries about $3K for human validation of the coding and travel, its only 2027 spending; the rest is volunteer time. Scholar Group outreach is limited in 2027 to the roughly 20 scholars the v1 panels need, and the first convening ($12K) waits for Tranche 2. Both feed the benchmarks.

**How we measure, in brief.** Four benchmarks, each built with scholars of its source, and five tasks: representation (what does a tradition teach?), application (advising someone who holds it), reasoning quality (the same case reworded), a say–do test of whether models act on stated values when it costs them their goal, and a sycophancy probe. Reference answers are written by each tradition's scholars and ratified by its panel, with dissent recorded; AI judges are used only where validated against human raters; every score ships with its capability correlation and refusal rate. Results are per-model profile reports with no composite score, badge or certification. A local-run kit for open-weight models is a stretch goal. The full design, validation plan and data protocol are in Appendix A.

## What we have built

In its first year, with no paid staff, CEI assembled the raw material for an open values-alignment platform and showed it can measure moral diversity at global scale. These are early proof points, not yet products in use.

| Asset | What it is | Scale | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Governance Symphony** study | Maps AI-governance statements into six recurring clusters of principles — including solidarity and religious-pastoral clusters that emerge when faith, labor and Indigenous sources are deliberately included. About 2,700 statements have so far been scored on 374 principles by two AI models used as a measured coding instrument (intraclass correlation 0.93 for the same model run twice, 0.79 across two vendors' models) | 5,140 statements collected · 3,897 organizations · 130 countries · 48 languages | Research poster co-authored with researchers at the University of Notre Dame and Harvard; human validation of the coding planned; full paper in preparation for a 2027 venue (AIES 2027 or NeurIPS 2027) |
| Moral benchmark catalog | A curated map of existing moral and values benchmarks and datasets; to be published as a gap analysis (what is non-Western, tradition-authored, or tests reasoning rather than verdicts) | 2,368 entries | Internal database; inclusion criteria to be published |

| Asset | What it is | Scale | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| Governance database | Formal AI governance documents from regulators, international bodies and governments | 5,140 statements | Living database, maintained by the AI Governance team |
| EthicsMosaic | Professional codes of conduct (medicine, law, engineering, finance, education) in machine-readable form | 7,041 codes · 661 organizations | Dataset; licensing not yet reviewed; no public release until it is |
| Benchmarks in development | Four benchmarks: normative ethics, moral psychology (exploratory in v1), the UN Universal Declaration of Human Rights, and Magnifica humanitas (in v1; CEI's draft is a pilot until the Catholic panel we are recruiting rewrites and ratifies it) | Prototypes: task specifications drafted and prototype items per module; no scored outputs, human ratings or registration yet | In active development; v1 brings them to the measurement design in Appendix A |

### Traction and relationships

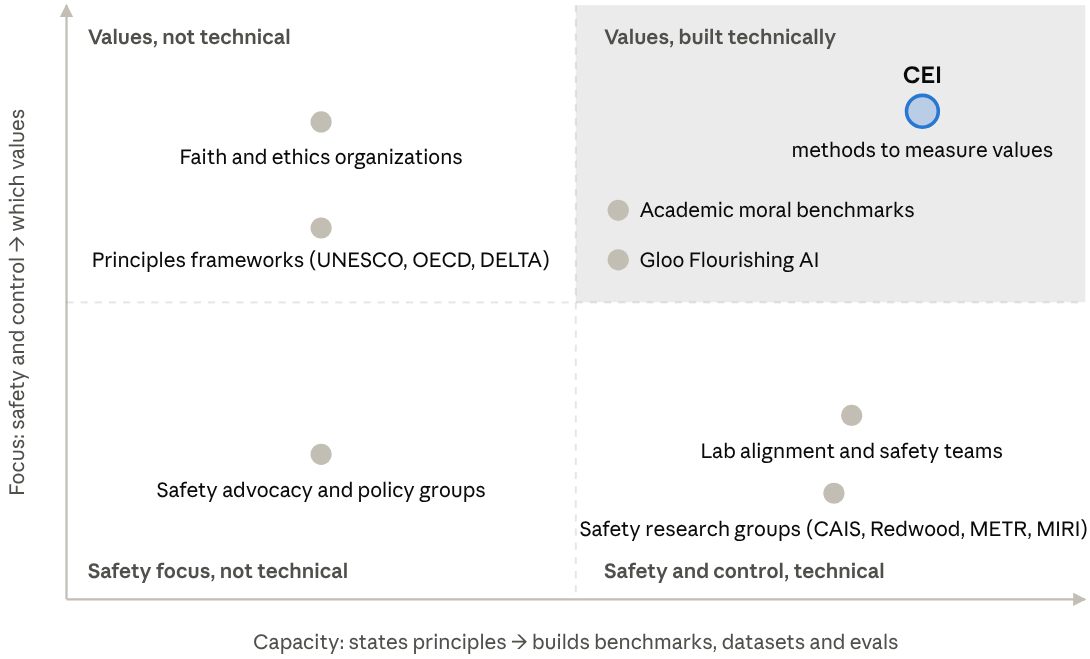
- **Convenings and talks:** Jimmy Lin was an invited participant in Anthropic's March 2026 summit of Christian leaders on AI and faith (a summit reported by the *Washington Post* and *New York Times*). He presented at the Berkeley CHAI workshop at Asilomar, the ARC conference in London and ASA 2026; Rui Guo spoke on China's AI governance at IAPP Navigate.
- **Academic work:** the Governance Symphony poster, co-authored with researchers at the University of Notre Dame and Harvard (full paper in preparation); an abstract on epiplexity presented at 5ICEAI (June 2026) and accepted at ICAIR 2026. No CEI paper is yet published or preprinted.

- **Funding to date:** a $7K+ rapid-response sub-award through Faith Work & Tech's Notre Dame DELTA grant and a $10K individual gift.
- **People:** about 40 volunteer researchers who take part as individuals (their day jobs include Google DeepMind, Meta, Scale AI, ByteDance, UC Berkeley, Harvard and Stanford), and a database of about 650 prospective Scholar Group members and advisors compiled from public sources across disciplines and traditions; no one has been contacted yet. In 2027 we contact the roughly 20 scholars the v1 panels need; broader outreach waits for Tranche 2.
- **Community:** selected as a 2027 Praxis Nonprofit Accelerator fellow.

## Landscape and differentiation

Two kinds of groups work near us: AI-safety groups, which mainly evaluate dangerous capabilities and deceptive tendencies and develop control methods (some, notably work led by the Center for AI Safety's director, have also built moral benchmarks that we build on), and values and ethics organizations, which articulate principles but rarely build technical tools. CEI sits between them, in the niche the executive summary describes.

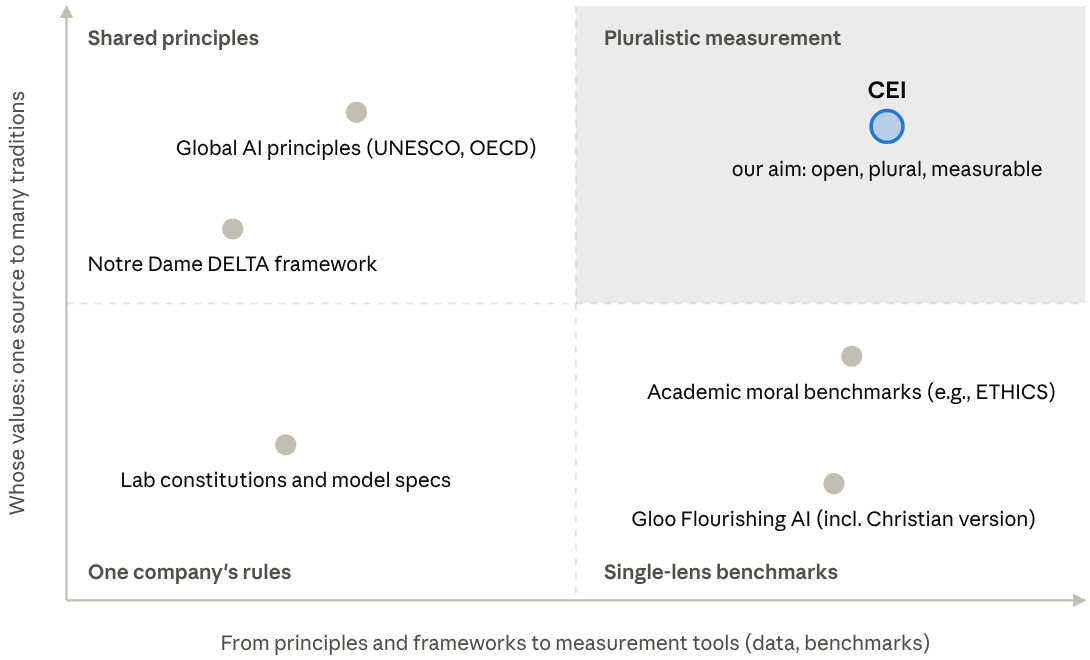
**CEI works where values alignment meets technical tools**




Alignment focus × technical capacity · positions are approximate zones

Few groups sit in the top-right quadrant, and those that do mostly measure through a single lens. The next picture shows how CEI differs from them: openness and many traditions.

**CEI aims for the open quadrant: many traditions, measurable tools**




Where CEI sits · positions are approximate zones, not scores

A peer-by-peer comparison, with where we would partner rather than compete, is in Appendix B.

**Why not leave this to others?** Better-funded groups could build parts of this, and we would rather partner than compete. What is hard to copy is the combination: modules authored by each tradition's own scholars, relationships of trust we are building across faith and secular communities, two large curated corpora (governance and professional ethics), and a neutral, open stance that no product company or single tradition can offer. Our full v1 has four benchmarks spanning philosophy, psychology, human rights and one faith tradition; "many traditions" is our direction, not yet our state.

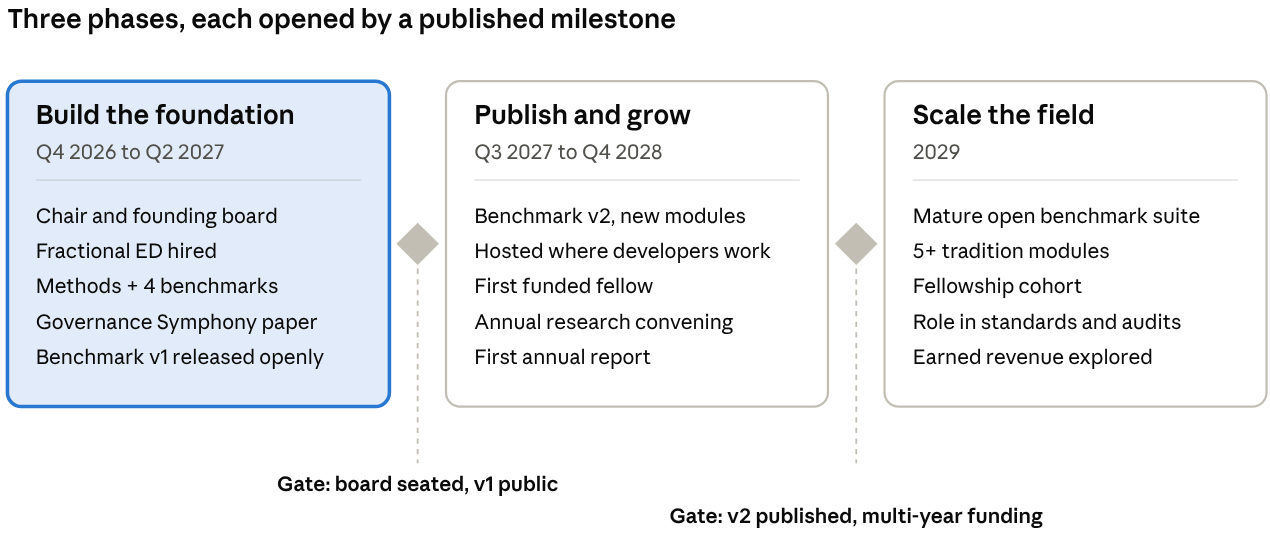
**If someone ships first.** Our durable asset is the open method plus independence, not any one module. If a lab publishes a values benchmark first, that helps us: it validates the category, and CEI becomes the independent re-run that compares. If a university consortium publishes a scholar-authored faith module first, we offer our behavioral tasks

(say–do and the sycophancy probe) and our method as that module's measurement layer rather than compete. We will open that conversation with the CEFE-AI consortium once v1 results exist, so that we come with a finding rather than a plan.

## Strategy and roadmap

We have made one strategic choice: **CEI is a research organization.** We run three programs (AI Alignment, AI Governance and the Scholar Group), and for the next 12 months one leads: publishing open values-alignment benchmarks. The other two feed that work, and we build the institution to sustain all three. Becoming a funder of others is not on our 2027–2029 path.

This focus follows the question Jim Collins poses for social-sector organizations in *Good to Great and the Social Sectors*: where do passion, distinctive capability and a resource engine overlap? For CEI, that overlap is open moral measurement.




CEI roadmap 2026–2029 · 3 phases, 2 gates

We move to the next phase only when its gate is met. Months count from the first paid hire. Publishing is our measure of success, and one stop rule binds us: if no one outside CEI has run the suite within 18 months of v1's release, the board will not fund a second version on the same distribution model.

**How the benchmark reaches users** (in this order): a public release with methods and data; a self-hosted Inspect task listed in the Inspect Evals register, with a published results schema, and hosting where developers already work (e.g., Hugging Face); outreach to a first frontier lab and to fast-growing open-model labs; designs that also run

on local and open-source models; and, later, a role in independent assessment. **The technical co-lead owns distribution,** on a fixed cadence: the development split runs on every major open-weight release within 14 days, with a short profile note; the private split runs on the formal schedule. Starting with one outside community (a stretch goal in v1), we invite stakeholders from additional traditions to build modules with our method, with CEI providing the toolkit, training and quality review. We will build partners deliberately — name them, connect, nurture the relationship, then tell their story — aiming for seven core partners by 2029.

**Messages for our three audiences.** Across all three, we lead with our approach (open, plural, measurable), not with how fast AI is moving.

| Audience | What they need to hear | What we lead with |
|---|---|---|
| AI labs and safety researchers | Independent, rigorous tests of how models represent and act on values, which they can run themselves | The technical brief; say–do results |
| The AI ethics and governance field | Many traditions, each authored by its own scholars, turned into usable measurement | Governance Symphony; the four benchmarks |
| Churches, Christian funders and leaders | A way for the church's moral wisdom to shape AI, rigorously and humbly, at a fair table | The Christian edition |

**What we will not do in 2027** — good ideas we are deliberately holding back so the flagship ships:

- Consulting, training and curriculum services
- A large faith-leader platform (we start with the roughly 20 scholars the v1 panels need, and community review panels)
- Training our own AI models (we supply the inputs; partners run experiments)
- New research topics beyond values alignment and governance
- Organizing large conferences (we start with one small research convening)

## Five priorities for the next 90 days (proposed)

Praxis asks each fellow to pick five things for the next three months and to name what they will say no to. Our proposal for November 2026 to January 2027:

1. **Seat a board chair** and invite the founding cohort, so that the chair and at least three independent directors are seated at one meeting.
2. **Name the people who hold the clock:** a volunteer operations lead (the first priority) and a technical co-lead. Design the Executive Director role, appoint a search committee of independent directors and build the comparables file; post only when nine months of the role's loaded cost has been received.
3. **Advance benchmark v1:** publish draft task specifications, share first pilot results on the development split (labeled exploratory), and recruit Catholic theologians for the encyclical module.
4. **Raise the first tranche:** ask board members and major donors for about $50K by March 31, 2027; ask for a DELTA rapid-response or partner grant; prepare the Survival and Flourishing Fund application for the 2027 round; open the Templeton conversation with a university co-applicant.
5. **Get the basics in order:** execute the sponsorship agreement, with the fee and dataset ownership in writing; adopt bylaws and bind D&O insurance; sign volunteer agreements; obtain the president's employer's written consent to the officer and interim-leader role.

**Saying no to, for these 90 days:** new programs, organizing conferences, consulting requests, and grant applications we cannot do well in the time available.

## Measuring impact

**The one outcome of the first 12 months:** a pre-registered result on the v1 core — two modules, one secular and one faith, plus the say–do pilot and the sycophancy probe — published with its validation statistics, and the full v1 of four benchmarks if Tranche 2 closes. Everything else below is a means to that or a stretch. Months count from the first paid hire. Outside use is the influence we hope follows: we track it and report it, and our success does not depend on any lab's decision. Following Bridgespan's "intended impact" discipline, each horizon names an outcome, the evidence we will report and the threshold we hold ourselves to.

| Horizon | Intended outcome | How we will know | Threshold |
|---|---|---|---|
| **12 months** | **Methods and benchmark v1 published** | The open method (templates, rubric guides, validation protocol, code) and v1 — the core on Tranche 1; the full four benchmarks (normative ethics, moral psychology as exploratory, UN human rights, Magnifica humanitas), plus the say–do module, on Tranche 2 — released with a datasheet | v1 preprinted and submitted to a peer-reviewed ML venue (target: the NeurIPS 2028 Evaluations & Datasets track, or ICLR 2028 if funding timing allows); at least 6 frontier and open models profiled; early pilot results published. Stretch, if Tranche 2 closes by mid-2027: a fifth module authored by an outside community and a local-run kit |
| **12 months** | Traditions recognize the work as faithful | Each partner panel ratifies its module's reference points; dissent is published | At least 80% of reference points per module ratified by two of three panel scholars, with the dissent rate published; named scholars credited on each module |
| **12 months** | The bridge runs both ways | Tests in standard harnesses for labs; plain-language briefs for communities | At least one harness integration (a self-hosted Inspect task listed in the register); a plain-language brief on v1 (one per benchmark as a stretch) |

| Horizon | Intended outcome | How we will know | Threshold |
|---|---|---|---|
| **12 months** | Evidence of rigor | Human agreement and judge validation reported; capability correlation and say–do gap published | AI judges reported only where judge–human α ≥ 0.80 on a held-out sample (0.67–0.80 reported as tentative with a 20% human audit); capability correlation below the pre-registered threshold (proposed 0.7) on at least three of five tasks |
| **12 months** | Research record | Peer-reviewed publications on our existing work | Governance Symphony submitted to AIES 2027 or NeurIPS 2027; benchmark-catalog gap analysis preprinted |
| **12 months** | Credible institution | Board with an independent majority; methods committee formed; the Executive Director in place once the nine-months rule is met; clean books | Board of seven to nine (three filed directors plus a chair and a founding cohort of three to five) with an independent majority; financials reviewed by an outside accountant |
| **12 months** | Voice for those affected | Practitioners and community reviewers shape each module | Share of items written or validated by practitioners and community reviewers, reported per module |
| **18 months** | **Someone outside CEI runs it** | Outside runs reported to the board | At least one organization outside CEI has run the suite and reported a result. If none has, the board does not fund a second version on the same distribution model: the stop rule |

| Horizon | Intended outcome | How we will know | Threshold |
|---|---|---|---|
| **3 years** | Method adopted by other traditions | Stakeholders in additional traditions build modules with our method | At least three tradition modules beyond v1; ≥2 major versions; governance and professional-ethics modules released |
| **3 years** | Field building | Researchers funded and convened | First fellows or postdocs funded; one annual convening |
| **Tracked, not required** | Influence | Who uses what we publish | Outside runs and reproductions; citations; labs, safety institutes or auditors reporting results |
| **10+ years** | Field norm | Values evaluation is standard practice | CEI's methods referenced in standards, audits or model documentation |

**Leading indicators we will report to the board each quarter,** with the funding-tier status at the top of every report: meetings and pilots with labs; outside runs and downloads of the benchmark; citations and media; tradition leads and community reviewers recruited; Scholar Group sessions held and members engaged; governance documents added; dollars received and committed against the plan.

**How we will hold ourselves honest.** We will publish failures alongside results ("progress, not success"), stop pilots that do not move these outcomes, and refresh this plan every three years in a two-page strategy the board adopts.

## Team and governance

CEI has two founders with complementary gifts, a committed volunteer network, and a plan to build an institution that does not depend on either founder.

**Founders**

- **Jimmy Lin, MD, PhD, MHS, MA (Religion) — Co-Founder and President.** Chief Scientific Officer at Freenome; previously at Natera, NIH and Johns Hopkins. Founder of Rare Genomics Institute (a 2012 Praxis venture) and Senior TED Fellow; theology thesis on Bavinck's anthropology applied to AI. *Brings:* vision, AI and science fluency, and relationships with labs, the church and funders.
- **Rui Guo, LLM, SJD — Co-Founder and Research Director.** Legal scholar of AI ethics and former Visiting Scholar at Harvard (2024–25). As a law professor in Beijing he helped write China's first AI standardization white paper (2018) and led its AI Ethical Risk Research Report (2019). That rare vantage on how nations govern AI is part of why we insist on open methods that anyone can inspect. *Brings:* research direction, governance and law, and academic and global networks.

Both founders serve part time as volunteers; neither is paid in any year of this plan. Until the first paid hire, the work is divided as follows.

**Who does what until the first paid hire**

| Role | Who | Responsible for | Through |
|---|---|---|---|
| President and interim leader | Jimmy Lin | About 15–20 hours a week: board formation, fundraising, and the v1 lead until the technical co-lead is appointed; reports monthly to the board through the chair | The earlier of the Executive Director's start or Sept 30, 2027, when the board renews or ends the arrangement in executive session |
| Research director | Rui Guo | About 10–20 hours a week: research direction, AI Governance and the Governance Symphony paper | Through 2027 |
| Technical co-lead | To be appointed (a 90-day priority) | v1's method and distribution; accountable to the board for the release date once appointed | — |

| Role | Who | Responsible for | Through |
|---|---|---|---|
| Volunteer operations lead | To be named; the first 90-day priority | Monthly reports, volunteer agreements and the operating rhythm | Until the Executive Director starts |
| Treasurer | An officer of the corporation | The monthly cash line | Until the Executive Director starts |

**Recusals.** While interim leader, the president does not vote on the Executive Director search, selection or pay, on his own evaluation, or on Methods Committee nominations, and does not supervise the Executive Director once hired. The chair checks founder hours against this table each quarter.

**Our volunteers and partners.** About 40 researchers contribute as volunteers across our AI Alignment and AI Governance teams, and the Scholar Group brings in academics from many disciplines and traditions, alongside co-authors at Notre Dame and Harvard. Because some volunteers work at labs we will evaluate, no one employed by an evaluated lab authors items, writes judge prompts or holds the private split for that lab's results, and affiliations are disclosed. Our commitment to them: contributor license agreements under open licenses (not assignments), named credit and authorship on what they build, stipends for tradition leads, and public thanks in every report.

**What we are adding in 2027**

In this order: the engineer, then the technical co-lead, then the fractional Executive Director once nine months of the role's loaded cost has been received, then the fellow with Tranche 2. The nine-months rule is defined in the Financial plan.

1. **Research engineer** — part time (about 500 hours), engaged first, on a fixed-term contract through our fiscal sponsor, to avoid hiring delay; builds the evaluation harness, data pipeline and evaluation server (the local-run kit is a stretch goal), with experience in standard tools (e.g., Inspect, lm-evaluation-harness, HELM).
2. **Technical co-lead** — a named evaluations lead with published work, the reviewers' first condition and our most important near-term recruit; an advisory engagement with defined deliverables, approved by the sponsor; owns v1's method and distribution; part time in 2028, full time from 2029.
3. **Executive Director** — the role is vacant, and we are recruiting with a clear role, budget and reporting line. The design is decided: a fractional Executive Director (about 60% time) employed through the sponsor in 2027, full time from 2028, reporting to the

board through the chair and named in the bylaws as chief executive. In the first 90 days the board designs the role, appoints a search committee of independent directors and builds the comparables file; the role is posted only when nine months of its loaded cost has been received. Pay figures are planning assumptions, set each year by the independent directors, founders absent, against three Bay Area comparables, minuted within 60 days, with the sponsor's approval while sponsored.

4. **Research fellow** — a computer-science fellow or postdoc hosted with a university partner, from mid-2027 with Tranche 2.
5. **Tradition partners and community reviewers** — scholars who author each module using our method, joined by practitioners and community members (including from the Global South) who review it.
6. **Advisors** — a measurement (psychometrics) advisor, and at least one secular AI-safety or ML researcher as a co-author on v1.

**Employees, not contractors.** The sponsor's rules and California's ABC test both point the same way: project leaders cannot be independent contractors, and core work is employee work. The Executive Director and the engineer are therefore sponsor employees in 2027, with a 13.5% payroll-tax load (employer taxes and workers' compensation; no benefits on part-time roles) and 25% with benefits from 2028. The co-lead is an advisory engagement with defined deliverables, approved by the sponsor.

**How we lead.** We want CEI to outlast its founders. Founder compensation will be set by independent directors, with founders recused — and, in practice, each founder advocates for the other. We commit to bringing major decisions to the board, to asking the chair to watch over founder health, and to sharing the stage with the people doing the work. How we keep ourselves as people of faith is in Appendix E.

**Governance.**

- **Entity.** CEI is a California nonprofit public benefit corporation (work began in 2024; Articles approved 2026). Its work runs as a fiscally sponsored project of Social Good Fund, a 501(c)(3), until CEI holds its own 501(c)(3) status; the structure is set out under Legal and operational readiness below.
- **Board today.** Three filed directors: Jimmy Lin, Rui Guo and Imran Babar (co-founder of Rare Genomics Institute). No independents and no chair yet.
- **Faith and the board: no seat on the board or on any committee carries a faith requirement. The founders are Christian and say so (Appendix E); the organization is governed by its mission, not by a confessional test**.

- **The methods committee decides inclusion and scoring.** Decisions about which traditions are included and how modules are scored rest with the independent methods committee, chartered by the board before any public release is scored. Members are nominated by the president, any two directors or the committee; at least two are scholars of religious traditions, at least one from a tradition other than Christianity, and a majority come from outside Christianity, the founders' tradition; membership is published, and the first cohort draws one-, two- and three-year terms by lot. The board binds itself by policy to carry out the committee's decisions, and sets one aside only by two-thirds of the directors in office, after 30 days' notice and with published reasons, and never substitutes its own method decision. The board funds any committee-approved module within the annual budget or says publicly why not. The committee chooses which traditions are included; it does not decide who speaks for a tradition.
- **Module authorship will span many traditions.** Today our strongest ties are Protestant, and we say so.
- **Seats we are filling:** faith leadership; philanthropy; AI industry; academic research; law and finance; and one seat for someone close to the communities most affected by AI. We will recruit for diversity of background, gender and generation.

| Step | What happens | When |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Recruit an independent chair | Q4 2026 |
| 2 | Seat the chair and a founding cohort of three to five independent directors at one meeting, with one-year first terms, giving the board an **independent majority before any paid role starts** | Q1 2027 |
| 3 | Form an **independent methods committee** — secular philosophers, ML researchers, a measurement specialist and scholars of religious traditions — that publishes the criteria for which traditions are included and reviews each module's method | Q1 2027 |

| Step | What happens | When |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | Adopt bylaws, the conflict-of-interest, related-party (founder pay), research-independence and data-access policies, and the three-year term classes | First board meeting |
| 5 | Form a multi-tradition **advisory committee**, separate from the fiduciary board | After v1, with the first outside-authored module (2028) |

## How the board works

- **Size and terms:** seven to nine directors with an independent majority; a one-year first term, then three-year terms in three classes, at most two consecutive. Quorum is a majority of directors in office; removal without cause takes two-thirds of directors in office. The chair and at least three independents are seated at one meeting.
- **Before any independent director joins:** bylaws with indemnification adopted, D&O insurance of at least $1M bound, and a secretary and a treasurer, neither of them the president or chair, in office as California requires.
- **Duties:** hire and review the Executive Director, who is the chief executive under the bylaws (subject to the sponsor's approval while sponsored); approve the budget and strategy; protect research independence.
- **Giving:** every board member gives personally each year at a level meaningful to them, with no minimum; as a board we aim to give or open doors to about $50K in 2027; board leaders give first.
- **Conflicts:** no director may be a current employee, officer, director or more-than-nominal investor in a company that develops frontier models or whose models CEI evaluates; one who becomes so resigns or takes leave. Directors disclose ties to funders, labs and partners each year, and recuse from related decisions and from pre-release access to that lab's results.
- **Culture:** a board that welcomes hard questions, with an executive session of independent directors, without the founders, at every meeting; the chair leads it and its substance reaches the president within a week.
- **Review:** a yearly board self-assessment and leader evaluation.
- **Structure:** a finance-and-audit committee and a governance committee; the advisory committee and the methods committee sit outside the board.

## Operating rhythm

| How often | What happens |
|---|---|
| Weekly | Leadership meeting: founders, the technical co-lead once appointed, and the Executive Director once hired |
| Monthly | Benchmark progress check against the timeline; the cash line: cash received against the three funding tiers, the sponsor statement reconciled and the pipeline updated (owner: the treasurer until the Executive Director starts); short funder updates |
| Quarterly | Board meeting and report against this plan, with the tier status at the top; each program reviewed to continue, change or stop |
| Yearly | Role reviews; board self-assessment; annual report; Scholar Group convening (the first funded by Tranche 2) |
| Every three years | A two-page strategy refresh adopted by the board |

## Legal and operational readiness

**Legal structure.**

- CEI is a California nonprofit public benefit corporation (work began in 2024; Articles approved 2026). Its work runs as a fiscally sponsored project of Social Good Fund, a 501(c)(3), under a Model C (pre-approved grant) sponsorship agreement at 6.5% of receipts.
- The sponsor holds all funds and grants for CEI, employs any staff, holds title to data and code created under sponsorship until they are released under open licenses, charges its fee on receipts, and has final approval of legal, financial and employment matters. Grant agreements are signed by the sponsor.
- CEI's directors govern the corporation and set program, policy and budget requests, and the Executive Director's hiring, subject to that approval. The board adopts a resolution releasing data and code under open licenses by default.

- The fee is 6.5% of receipts, Social Good Fund's Model C rate, and runs until the mid-2029 transfer to our own 501(c)(3). The sponsor employs the 2027 Executive Director and engineer.
- **The 2029 transition.** We plan to file Form 1023 in Q1 2028 and to transfer funds, staff and data to CEI in mid-2029, once the determination letter is in hand and each funder has consented to the transfer of its grant. The sponsor's fee runs until the move is complete, and the 2029 budget carries a one-time $20K transition line (legal, duplicate insurance, payroll setup, asset and grant transfers).

| Item | Status | Owner | Target date |
|---|---|---|---|
| California nonprofit corporation | Articles approved 2026 | President | Done |
| Fiscal sponsorship (Social Good Fund) | In place; the executed agreement states the model, fee and data terms | President | Before the first board meeting |
| Bylaws (indemnification; the Executive Director as chief executive; board size, quorum, removal and terms) | To adopt | Board, drafted by the president with counsel | Before any independent director joins |
| D&O insurance (at least $1M) | To bind | Treasurer | Before any independent director joins |
| Officers: secretary and treasurer | In office before any outside director joins, as California requires; recorded in the Statement of Information | President | Q4 2026 |
| State filings: Statement of Information; Attorney General registration within 30 days of first holding assets; state exemption filing | Filed as each falls due | Treasurer, with counsel | Q4 2026 – Q1 2027 |

| Item | Status | Owner | Target date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Funds, accounts and accounting | Through the sponsor's account for CEI while sponsored; CEI's own accounts open when funds transfer | Treasurer | Mid-2029 |
| CEI's own 501(c)(3) status | Form 1023 to file | President, with counsel | Q1 2028 |
| Volunteer agreements (intellectual property, credit, confidentiality) | To sign with about 40 contributors | Volunteer operations lead | Q1 2027 |
| Dataset licensing (EthicsMosaic) | Review before release | Research director | Before any release |
| Ethics review (IRB) for human raters | Route to be chosen with the first hire (an independent ethics board or a university partner's IRB); budgeted in Tranche 1 | Technical co-lead | Before gold-set rating begins |
| Policies: conflict of interest, independence, data access | Drafted in this plan, for board adoption | Board | First board meeting |

## How we use AI in our own work

AI tools help us scan the literature, code data and draft test items; today under half of the prototype items are AI-drafted. We disclose that use, label AI-assisted material as such, and count only human-reviewed work as research. Where AI drafts a test item, the drafting model family is recorded in the item's record and the tradition's scholars rewrite the item rather than approve it. Anything public that was generated by AI, including audio, says so.

# Funding model

Our long-term aim is the model the *Ten Nonprofit Funding Models* study calls a "Big Bettor": research infrastructure sustained by a few foundations and major donors who back a large, long-horizon goal. Today we are building a diversified early base across four channels, and we approach every funder as a partner in a shared purpose, not a source of transactions.

**Four channels, one story.**

| Channel | Who | Why they fund us | Near-term opportunities |
|---|---|---|---|
| Faith-based foundations | Lilly Endowment (reached through Notre Dame's DELTA network), Templeton, the DELTA network and peers | Moral wisdom shaping AI, done with intellectual rigor | **Checked Oct 31, 2026.** A DELTA rapid-response or partner grant (the earliest money, Q1 2027). DELTA Partner Program Phase 2 ($500K–$1M impact grants, open to new applicants, no date posted). Templeton's 2026 cycle has closed and its 2027 dates are unannounced; a 2027 proposal, with a university co-applicant, pays in 2028 at the earliest. Lilly's religion grants are invitational, so our route to Lilly is DELTA |

| Channel | Who | Why they fund us | Near-term opportunities |
|---|---|---|---|
| AI-safety and science funders | Survival and Flourishing Fund, Foresight Institute; later Coefficient Giving and the Frontier Model Forum AI Safety Fund (industry-funded) | Independent tests of value specifications; say–do evaluation; decentralized oversight that no one lab controls | **Checked Oct 31, 2026.** SFF's 2027 round (its Fairness track funds inclusive AI governance; fiscally sponsored projects are eligible; decisions in September). Foresight's AI for Science & Safety Nodes program, if a round opens in 2027: an application is drafted (about $48K; the say–do suite, run locally by any community; everything funded is released open). The Future of Life Institute's religious-projects RFP closed and completed in 2026 with no repeat announced. Coefficient Giving and the FMF fund later |
| Technology-ethics philanthropy | Humanity AI coalition ($500M; MacArthur, Omidyar Network, Ford, Mellon and others) | People-centered AI; independent voices | **Checked Oct 31, 2026.** Humanity AI's open call closed in October 2026 and excludes research-only projects, so introductions only, through Praxis and board networks, to member foundations' own processes |

| Channel | Who | Why they fund us | Near-term opportunities |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major donors | Board members, The Gathering, the Praxis community, technology leaders | Belief in the mission and the team | Founding circle: general operating support that founds the institution; the research engineer or compute; a named fellowship |

**Matching the ask to the funder.** We match each ask to what the funder funds: Templeton, a two-year research project with a named lead and outputs (does AI act on the values it professes?), built with a university co-applicant; Lilly, through DELTA; major donors and the board, general operating support: the Executive Director, payroll, legal, insurance, the sponsor fee and the institution itself, which no foundation on our list funds. AI-safety funders fund research, so we pitch them the research lines — a technical co-lead, the engineer, compute, and the say–do and sycophancy work — framed honestly as values-and-pluralism research with a specific safety contribution. Funders that expect a direct catastrophic-risk mechanism (such as the Long-Term Future Fund) are a poor fit today; Coefficient Giving and the FMF fund become realistic once v1 shows validated, safety-relevant results. Coefficient Giving (formerly Open Philanthropy) had no AI calls open in October 2026 and finds most grants through its own research, so we build that relationship early. The research fellow is the kind of role DELTA's faith-and-AI faculty fellowships fund, and we will route it there when a round opens.

**Grant ladder.** Small grants (under $10K) build a track record; mid-size grants ($30K–$150K) fund the engineer, the co-lead, compute and annotation; general operating gifts from individuals fund the Executive Director and the institution; large multi-year awards ($500K+) build lasting capacity.

**Earned revenue later, not now.** Advisory, training and certification services could follow once our methods are established, but they need a dedicated team and will not distract from publishing in 2027.

**Independence safeguards** (adopted as the planning basis on Nov 1, 2026; the board ratifies them at its first meeting):

- No more than **15% of annual revenue** from any single AI company. "AI company" includes its affiliates, its employees' matching gifts and its in-kind support, counted at fair value.

- No more than **40% of annual revenue** from industry money of all kinds, including industry-pooled funds such as the Frontier Model Forum fund, fully disclosed.
- Caps are tested against final annual revenue; a gift that turns out to breach a cap is returned, reduced or deferred, and disclosed.
- One exemption, disclosed: researcher-access compute credits from vendors in 2027, drawn from more than one vendor where possible, may exceed the 15% cap in that year only; the exemption and the credits' fair value are reported in the annual report.
- Any gift over **30% of annual revenue**, from any source, is reviewed by the independent directors and disclosed.
- No funder may review, veto or edit research results before publication; labs see their own results only under a fixed embargo.
- No badges or certifications of any model or company, and no composite score.
- Corporate and institutional funders are disclosed publicly; the board reviews any gift over **$25K** for conflicts; any gift from an AI company, its founders or employees is disclosed and reviewed at any size; directors recuse from the review of their own gifts; and in-kind compute from several vendors is preferred to cash from one lab.

**How we care for funders.**

- Every funder hears from us at least quarterly, with setbacks as well as wins.
- We track each relationship, mark milestones with short personal notes, and invite funders to our convenings.
- We learn what each funder cares about and ask for what fits that, not just what fills our budget gap.
- Over time we invite program funders to become mission funders, backing CEI's work as a whole.
- We ask every funder and board member: who else should we be talking to?

## Financial plan

Our 2027 budget is about **$308K**, raised in two tranches. **Hiring order: the engineer first, then the technical co-lead, then the fractional Executive Director once nine months of the role's loaded cost has been received, then the fellow with Tranche 2,** with the AI compute and infrastructure to build and run the benchmarks in Tranche 1. We plan in scenarios tied to decisions and commit spending only against money in hand. A five-year workbook (CEI Budget v4, 2027–2031) sits beside this plan with a conservative and an aggressive path; its 2027 column is the table below.

**Where we are today.** About $7K awarded to date (a rapid-response sub-award through Faith Work & Tech's Notre Dame DELTA grant, not yet received); near-zero burn because all work is volunteer; no debt; and nothing committed for 2027, so we are raising now. A Foresight Institute application (about $48K) is drafted and held for a future round.

**2027 budget (draft estimates for board review; the aggressive path's first year)**

| Line | Tranche 1: Foundation | Tranche 2: Research capacity | Basis |
|---|---|---|---|
| Executive Director (fractional, about 60% time, sponsor-employed) | $60K | — | Pro-rated from 2026 California small-nonprofit ED benchmarks ($85K–$115K full time; ExecSearches, Candid) |
| Research engineer (part-time contract, about 500 hours) | $50K | — | Evaluation harness, data pipeline, evaluation server |
| Payroll taxes on sponsor-employed roles (13.5%) | $15K | — | Employer taxes and workers' compensation; no benefits on part-time roles in 2027 |
| Technical co-lead (advisory engagement, defined deliverables) | $10K | — | A named evaluations lead with published work, the reviewers' first condition; part time in 2028, full time from 2029 |
| AI tokens, compute and judge validation | $34K | — | One frontier run of five models on five modules at about $1,200 per model per module ($30K), the sixth model open-weight and run locally ($1K), and $3K for judge validation and reruns; researcher-access credits are the slack |

| Line | Tranche 1: Foundation | Tranche 2: Research capacity | Basis |
|---|---|---|---|
| Data and evaluation infrastructure (hosting, evaluation server, storage) | $6K | — | Estimate |
| AI Governance (human validation of the coding, travel) | $3K | — | The program's only 2027 spending; the rest is volunteer time |
| Methods Committee honoraria | $2K | — | Members may also serve pro bono |
| Legal, accounting, insurance and ethics review | $12K | — | Includes D&O before any outside director joins and an ethics-review determination |
| IT, website and the sponsor's monthly cost | $3.5K | — | Estimate |
| Travel and board | $2.5K | — | Estimate |
| Fundraising | $2K | — | Separated from program travel because most grants will not pay it |
| Research fellow or postdoc (hosted with a university partner) | — | $38K | $75K a year, starting mid-2027 when the second tranche closes; depends on host and benefits |
| Expert annotation and tradition leads (stipends and gold-set rating) | — | $40K | About $8K per v1 module: the v1 modules are authored by scholars already working with CEI, with honoraria; modules authored by a new tradition partner from 2028 are priced at $30K |

| Line | Tranche 1: Foundation | Tranche 2: Research capacity | Basis |
|---|---|---|---|
| Scholar Group convening and annual report | — | $12K | Estimate |
| Fiscal sponsor fee (6.5% of funds raised under the Model C agreement) | about $14K | about $6K | Social Good Fund's Model C rate on all receipts |
| **Total** | **about $212K** | **about $96K** | **about $308K** |

There is no reserve contribution in 2027; the reserve starts in 2028 from unrestricted gifts.

**What each tranche unlocks.** Tranche 1 seats the board, engages the engineer and the technical co-lead, hires the Executive Director once the nine-months rule is met, and builds the method, the evaluation harness and the v1 core: two modules (one secular, one faith) plus the say–do pilot and the sycophancy probe. Tranche 2 adds the research fellow, expert annotation for the other two modules and the convening, and funds the public release of the full v1. If only Tranche 1 is raised, we publish the method and the v1 core on the development split; the public release waits for Tranche 2.

**Four dated tiers** (proposed; months count from the first paid hire):

| Received by March 31, 2027 | What we do |
|---|---|
| Under $60K | All-volunteer: spend only on legal, sponsor, insurance and compute credits; a two-module preprint with the say–do and sycophancy pilots |
| $60K–$120K | Engineer contracted; the president as interim leader; a two-module preprint; v1 in 2028 (the Conservative path) |
| $120K–$210K | Engineer and technical co-lead; four modules on the development split; no test split or profile reports |
| $210K or more | We proceed as planned: full v1 within 12 months of the first paid hire; public release contingent on Tranche 2 by mid-2027 |

No foundation on our list can pay before mid-2027, so Tranche 1 rests on board members, major donors and rapid-response grants.

**The nine-months rule.** No paid role, employee or contractor, starts until nine months of its fully loaded cost has been received into the sponsor's account for CEI; every 2027 role is an initial nine-to-twelve-month term, renewable on funding, and candidates are told so. The 12-month clock to v1 starts the day the first paid role starts.

**Burn and runway.** Tranche 1 alone runs about $17K a month once all its roles have started (about $200K over twelve months). The full 2027 plan averages about $24K a month but climbs through the year as hires land: about $10K a month in the first quarter, $23K in the second, $30K in the third and $33K in the fourth (workbook, "2027 cash" sheet). Cash on January 1, 2028 is close to zero against 2028 spending of about $59K a month, so the 2028 raise must be under way by mid-2027. The nine-months rule holds the Executive Director's start until the sponsor account for CEI covers about $51K.

**Five-year outlook (2027–2031).** The workbook (CEI Budget v4) carries three paths on one staffing plan and method. The Floor path is what survives if the institutional raise never closes: $120K a year keeps a part-time engineer, open-weight models and two to three volunteer-authored modules alive, still fiscally sponsored. The Conservative path keeps the revenue line of our earlier five-year budget; the Aggressive path starts at this plan's

full 2027 ask and then follows that budget's upside case. On the two funded paths the reserve, measured against the following year's budget, holds about a month and a half by 2030 and reaches three months in 2031; neither pays a founder in any year.

| Path | 2027 | 2028 | 2029 | 2030 | 2031 | Five years |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Floor: revenue | $100K | $120K | $120K | $120K | $120K | $580K |
| Floor: spending | $89K | $100K | $112K | $108K | $108K | $518K |
| Conservative: revenue | $100K | $600K | $1.3M | $2.2M | $3.5M | $7.7M |
| Conservative: spending | $89K | $526K | $1.16M | $1.94M | $3.06M | $6.8M |
| Conservative: people paid by CEI (plus hosted fellows) | 1 | 3 (+1) | 5 (+1) | 6 (+1) | 9 (+1) | — |
| Aggressive: revenue | $308K | $800K | $1.8M | $3.0M | $5.0M | $10.9M |
| Aggressive: spending | $288K | $707K | $1.53M | $2.65M | $4.24M | $9.4M |
| Aggressive: people paid by CEI (plus hosted fellows) | 3 (+1) | 3 (+1) | 4 (+1) | 7 (+1) | 10 (+3) | — |

*What each path achieves.* On the Floor path CEI stays a volunteer method-and-data project with one part-time engineer: a two-module preprint in 2027, a third module by 2029, results on six models a year, and a method others can reuse. On the Conservative path, 2027 stays mostly volunteer with a part-time engineer and a two-module preprint; v1 ships in 2028 with a full-time Executive Director and the research fellow; the engineer goes full time and the first associates join in 2029; by 2031 CEI maintains eleven modules on sixteen models in two languages with nine people paid by CEI and a hosted fellow. On the Aggressive path, v1 ships within twelve months of the first paid hire with a fractional ED, a part-time contract engineer and a technical co-lead; the ED and engineer go full time in 2028; the co-lead goes full time in 2029 and a research scientist, second associate and operations manager follow by 2030; by 2031 CEI maintains fourteen modules on twenty models in three languages, run twice a year, with ten people paid by CEI and three hosted fellows. On every path the method, the datasheet and the profile reports are public; the Aggressive path is faster, broader, and the reference others build on sooner.

*Shared assumptions.* Executive Director pay figures are planning assumptions, not offers: fractional at $60K in 2027 and full time from 2028 at about $120K, with each later step set each year by the independent directors, founders absent, against a file of at least three comparable Bay Area research nonprofits, minuted within 60 days, with the sponsor's approval while sponsored. Hiring order: the engineer, then the technical co-lead, then the

fractional Executive Director once nine months of the role's loaded cost has been received, then the research fellow with Tranche 2, then associates from 2029. Payroll taxes at 13.5% on sponsor-employed roles in 2027 and 25% with benefits from 2028; a 6.5% fiscal-sponsor fee (Social Good Fund's Model C rate) until the mid-2029 transfer to our own 501(c)(3), with a one-time $20K transition line in 2029; a 5% contingency from 2029; a reserve funded from 2028 out of each year's surplus, up to the target and never from restricted grants, toward three months of the following year's spending (none in 2027). Unit costs: about $1,200 per model per module for each full run, with two runs a year at most and rotation re-scoring; about $8K of honoraria per v1 module, and $30K to build a module with a new tradition partner's scholars from 2028; $5K per module a year for item rotation; $10K one-time translation per module-language pair, plus maintenance; $30K per independent red-team audit; $15K per human-baseline study.

**Unit costs (estimates).** Tranche 1 (about $212K) builds the method and the v1 core; Tranche 2 (about $96K) adds two modules, the fellow and the public release. Each additional tradition module, once the method exists, costs roughly $20K–$40K (annotation, honoraria, compute; the workbook plans at $30K) — the main way our work scales. Keeping published benchmarks current costs about $5K per module a year for item rotation plus the full runs: for six modules on eight models run twice, with re-scoring after item rotation, about $170K in 2028.

**Pipeline.** Committed: about $7K (awarded, not yet received). Pending: none. The rows below are planning probabilities, revised monthly; the owner is the president for individuals and faith funders and the research director for AI-safety and science funders.

| Funder | Ask | Stage | Earliest decision | Planning probability | Owner | Expected value in 2027 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Board members and major donors | $50K | Asked from November 2026 | March 2027 | 70% | President | $35K |
| A DELTA rapid-response or partner grant | $15K | To ask | Q1 2027 | 50% | President | $7.5K |
| Survival and Flourishing Fund (Fairness track) | $100K | Apply in the 2027 round | September 2027 | 25% | Research director | $25K |
| Foresight Institute | $48K | Application drafted; if a round opens in 2027 | When a round is announced | 30% | Research director | $14.4K |

| Funder | Ask | Stage | Earliest decision | Planning probability | Owner | Expected value in 2027 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| DELTA Partner Program Phase 2 | $100K+ | To ask; no date posted | None posted | 20% for 2027 | President | $20K |
| Templeton 2027 cycle, with a university co-applicant | $150K | To develop | 2028 money | 15% | President | — (none expected in 2027) |
| **Probability-weighted 2027 total** | | | | | | **about $100K** |

The probability-weighted 2027 total is about $100K; with the $7K awarded, our expected 2027 resources sit in the $60K–$120K tier. The $308K ask is the Aggressive path; our identified pipeline today supports the Conservative one. The board-and-major-donor row is a founding circle of three to five people giving $10K or more by Mar 31, 2027, mostly unrestricted.

**Sources and uses, 2027.** Who we expect to pay each line, and where each ask stands.

| Line | Tranche 1 | Tranche 2 | Expected source | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Executive Director | $60K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| Research engineer | $50K | — | AI-safety and science funders | Not yet asked |
| Payroll taxes on sponsor-employed roles | $15K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| Technical co-lead | $10K | — | AI-safety and science funders | Not yet asked |
| AI tokens, compute and judge validation | $34K | — | AI-safety and science funders; may be offset by researcher-access credits from vendors | Not yet asked |

| Line | Tranche 1 | Tranche 2 | Expected source | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Data and evaluation infrastructure | $6K | — | AI-safety and science funders | Not yet asked |
| AI Governance | $3K | — | Faith and research funders (a DELTA rapid-response grant) | Not yet asked |
| Methods Committee honoraria | $2K | — | Board and major donors, or research funders | Asked; nothing committed |
| Legal, accounting, insurance and ethics review | $12K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| IT, website and the sponsor's monthly cost | $3.5K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| Travel and board | $2.5K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| Fundraising | $2K | — | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| Research fellow or postdoc | — | $38K | Faith and research funders (a DELTA fellowship or SFF) | Not yet asked |
| Expert annotation and tradition leads | — | $40K | Faith and research funders (a DELTA partner grant; Templeton from 2028) | Not yet asked |
| Scholar Group convening and annual report | — | $12K | Faith funders | Not yet asked |

| Line | Tranche 1 | Tranche 2 | Expected source | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fiscal sponsor fee | about $14K | about $6K | Board and major donors (general operating) | Asked; nothing committed |
| **Total** | **about $212K** | **about $96K** | | |

About $114K of the year — the Executive Director, payroll taxes, legal, IT, travel, fundraising and the sponsor fee — is general operating cost that only individuals pay, because every foundation on our list funds research. Compute may be offset by vendor credits; annotation, the fellow and the convening are what faith and research funders pay for.

**Financial discipline.** Funds flow through our fiscal sponsor until independent 501(c)(3) status. We will keep clean books from day one, report to the board quarterly with a monthly cash line in between, build toward a three-month operating reserve from unrestricted gifts, and never commit spending against unconfirmed grants. If 2027 falls short, the cut order is the convening first, then the timing of annotation, then the fellow's start.

*All line items are planning estimates to be finalized with the board; salary ranges come from 2026 California and Bay Area nonprofit executive benchmarks (ExecSearches, Candid). The workbook sets founder compensation at $0 in every year, payroll taxes at 13.5% on sponsor-employed roles in 2027 and 25% with benefits from 2028, a 5% contingency from 2029 and a three-month reserve measured against the following year's spending; recruiting fees for a full-time Executive Director search are budgeted in 2028. The engineer line buys roughly 500 contract hours at Bay Area rates, about a quarter of a full-time year.*

## Risks and mitigations

Our largest risks are focus, founder capacity and demand. The board reviews these twelve each quarter; twelve further risks, reviewed yearly, are in Appendix D.

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Founder capacity and key-person dependence** | High | Both founders are part time; the Executive Director seat is vacant | The engineer engaged first, then the technical co-lead, then the fractional Executive Director once nine months of the loaded cost is received; the president as interim leader through the earlier of the Executive Director′s start or Sept 30, 2027, with a volunteer operations lead named in the first 90 days; the chair′s quarterly check of founder hours; documented processes |
| **No committed 2027 funding** | High | Nothing is committed for 2027, and no foundation on our list can pay before mid-2027, so early hires rest on board and major-donor gifts and rapid-response grants | The four dated tiers in the Financial plan, tested on March 31, 2027, and the nine-months rule; the monthly cash line; the cut order (convening, annotation timing, the fellow′s start) |
| **Trying to do everything** | High | Good ideas (services, platforms, conferences) could crowd out publishing | One flagship for 12 months; a written "not now" list; quarterly program review |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Demand: no one outside CEI runs what we publish** | High | Labs have asked for dialogue, not tests; benchmarks are adopted by a first user who helped design them | A design partner: one evaluation organization runs the development split before release; a self-hosted Inspect task listed in the register; the development split run on every major open-weight release within 14 days, with a profile note; the stop rule: no outside run within 18 months of v1's release means no second version on the same distribution model |
| **Measurement validity** | Medium–High | Scores may track general capability or wording rather than values, and experts may disagree on the right answers | A defined construct for each task; expert gold sets with reported agreement; AI judges reported only at judge–human $\alpha \geq 0.80$ on a held-out sample, from more than one vendor; capability correlation reported against a pre-registered threshold; sample sizes stated, with small per-tradition results labeled exploratory; an independent methods committee |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Benchmark gaming and contamination** | Medium | Models trained on test items look better than they are | A private held-out split run through an evaluation server; canary strings; regular item rotation and retirement; separate training datasets |
| **Methodology contested ("whose values?")** | Medium | Critics may dispute how traditions are represented or scored | Tradition-authored rubrics; benchmarks grounded in philosophy, psychology and human rights as well as faith; an independent methods committee; published methods; open comment periods |
| **Politicization** | Medium | Results could be used to label models as favoring one side or faith | Per-model profile reports with no composite score, badge or certification; describe rather than rank |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Perceived capture by AI companies** | Medium | We evaluate the labs we work with | Proposed independence policy, for adoption at the first board meeting: 15% cap per company (affiliates, matching gifts and in-kind at fair value included), 40% cap on industry money in total, caps tested on final revenue with a remedy, the 2027 compute-credit exemption disclosed, lab-affiliated directors barred, disclosure and review of any gift from an AI company at any size, director recusal on their own gifts, no funder review of results |
| **Licensing and intellectual property** | Medium | Professional codes may carry copyright; volunteer work needs clear terms; the sponsor holds title to data and code until release | Licensing review before releasing EthicsMosaic; signed volunteer agreements; the open-license default adopted by board resolution; the executed sponsorship agreement's data terms |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **A crowded field** | Medium | Gloo, the AllFaith consortium, FaithfulBench and IslamicLegalBench released faith benchmarks in 2025–26; funders may ask why another | Partner rather than duplicate; our durable asset is the open method plus independence; lead with what others lack (the say–do test against tradition-stated values, a scholar-recognized *Magnifica humanitas* module, the governance corpus); compare with peers in every paper; open the CEFE-AI conversation once v1 results exist |
| **Public record lags the plan** | Medium | Our website is out of date (the president updates it in November 2026), and our papers and partnerships are not yet public; funders and reviewers will check | Update the website; describe accepted work accurately (conference presentations); name partners only with their agreement |

## The invitation

AI will be aligned to something. We believe people of deep moral conviction should help decide what — openly, rigorously and with humility. We are inviting a small founding group to build this with us while the field, and CEI, are still taking shape.

**For prospective board members.** We are looking for people who share the mission and bring wisdom, networks and generosity. What we ask:

- About four board meetings a year (mostly virtual) plus one committee or project you care about: five to eight hours a month in the first year.
- A personal gift each year that is meaningful to you, with no minimum, and a willingness to open doors to funders, scholars and labs; as a board, we aim to give or open doors to about $50K in 2027.

- A one-year first term, so we can discover together whether the fit is right; then three-year terms, at most two consecutive.
- Courage to ask hard questions — we want a board that holds us to what we publish, not what we intend.

What you can expect from us: no surprises, quarterly reports against this plan, and a real role in shaping how AI's values are formed.

**For funders.** We do not want only your gift; we want you to walk with us. You will be invited to our convenings and you will hear our setbacks as well as our wins. If another organization fits your calling better, we will gladly introduce you. Our first priorities for 2027:

| Opportunity | Amount | What it makes possible |
|---|---|---|
| **Found the institution** (general operating; the founding circle) | $60K–$100K | The Executive Director, payroll, legal, accounting, insurance, IT, fundraising and the sponsor fee: the costs that turn a volunteer network into a lasting institution, and that no research grant pays |
| **Fund the research engineer** | $50K | A part-time engineer (about 500 hours) who builds the evaluation harness, data pipeline and evaluation server |
| **Fund the technical co-lead** | $10K | A named evaluations lead with published work who owns v1's method and its distribution |
| **Fund AI compute and infrastructure** | $40K | The tokens, compute, judge validation and hosting to build, run and publish the benchmarks |
| **Fund the research fellow** | $38K in 2027 ($75K a year) | A dedicated researcher building the benchmarks from mid-2027, hosted with a university partner |
| **Seat a v1 module's scholars** | about $8K | Honoraria and gold-set rating for one of the four v1 modules |

| Opportunity | Amount | What it makes possible |
|---|---|---|
| **Sponsor a tradition module after v1** | $20K–$40K | A new tradition partner's scholars and community reviewers who author one tradition's contribution (the workbook plans at $30K) |
| **Underwrite the Scholar Group's first convening** | $12K | Scholars across disciplines and traditions gathered for deep work on values alignment |

**For advisors and scholars.** Join the Scholar Group or our advisory committee, or help author or review a module, so that your tradition, discipline or community has a voice at the table.

**Next step.** A 30-minute conversation with Jimmy Lin and Rui Guo. Contact: info@ethical-intel.org.

# Appendix A: Measurement design and validation

The full design of the benchmark: what each task asks and how it is scored, how we validate, the two products, and how results are published. It sits here so the plan reads in one sitting; the body carries a summary.

## Measurement design

Each dimension will have a written specification, item template, gold-answer format and validation study, published before any model is scored.

**The method is the product.** CEI's core contribution is a reusable, open method (item templates, rubric-writing guides, validation protocols and evaluation code) that turns a body of moral wisdom into rigorous tests. v1 demonstrates it on four benchmarks, built with partner scholars, that each answer to a different set of stakeholders: the v1 core (two modules, one secular and one faith, plus the say–do pilot and the sycophancy probe) on Tranche 1, and the full four on Tranche 2. As a stretch goal, if Tranche 2 closes by mid-2027, one outside community pilots the method by authoring a fifth module, with CEI only reviewing quality. After v1, we approach stakeholders in other traditions (scholarly societies, seminaries and religious institutions, professional associations and communities) to build their own modules, with CEI providing the toolkit, training and quality review.

**Our first users** are evaluation organizations and open-model labs, because frontier labs have asked for dialogue, not tests. Our beneficiaries are the patients, students, workers, faith communities and people in the Global South who live with AI decisions they did not shape; policymakers who need public evidence are the third audience.

**The first four benchmarks** (in active development)

| Benchmark | Built on | What it tests | Whose moral wisdom it reflects |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Normative ethics** | Virtue, deontological, utilitarian and care ethics | Whether models represent each framework accurately, apply it to cases, and reason consistently within it | Moral philosophy |
| **Moral psychology** (exploratory in v1) | Moral Foundations Theory, Kohlberg's stages of moral development, Schwartz's theory of basic values | Models' value profiles, reported descriptively and compared with human data; v1 makes no developmental-stage claims and no profile claims until the instruments are shown stable on models | Empirical social science across cultures |
| **Human rights** | The UN Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948) | Whether models recognize and uphold the rights it names in realistic cases | A widely adopted international text, read with its own scholars and practitioners |

| Benchmark | Built on | What it tests | Whose moral wisdom it reflects |
|---|---|---|---|
| ***Magnifica humanitas*** (one encyclical within Catholic social teaching; in v1; CEI's draft is a pilot until the Catholic panel we are recruiting rewrites and ratifies it) | Pope Leo XIV's encyclical *Magnifica humanitas* (2026) | Whether models represent and apply the encyclical's teaching faithfully, with each item tied to paragraph numbers and labeled by level of teaching (categorical, principle or prudential); closed-book and open-book results reported side by side, since the text is newer than many models' training data. The current draft is CEI's and will be rewritten under a Catholic panel; no item is final until that panel is named | A living faith tradition, read with its own scholars |

Together they show the method working across very different stakeholders and worldviews: philosophical, scientific, international-legal and religious. v1 is Western and single-faith by design; the method is built so other traditions can author their own modules. The traditions whose scholars have published on AI are those we will approach first; the methods committee decides the order, sets each module's scope (a text, a school or a whole tradition) and publishes its reasons.

| Task | What it asks | How it is scored |
|---|---|---|
| **Representation** | "What does tradition X teach about this case, and why?" | Claim by claim, against reference points written by that tradition's scholars, each labeled settled, contested or not addressed, so a correct hedge earns full credit and false balance on a settled point is penalized; a view counts as fairly represented only when its own scholars agree |
| **Application** | Advising a person who holds tradition X | Against the tradition's own rubric, rated by its scholars. A partner decides whether this task applies to its module: where the tradition holds that guidance belongs to a qualified human authority, the reference answer represents the range of positions, declines to rule and refers the person to that authority, and a model that rules is penalized |
| **Reasoning quality** | The same case reworded, reframed, reordered, or with irrelevant details added | Consistency across variants — mostly without an AI judge |

| Task | What it asks | How it is scored |
|---|---|---|
| **Say–do** (small v1 module) | Agentic scenarios with tool use in which acting on a stated value costs the model a goal set by an operator system prompt, at three levels of cost (inconvenience; task failure; task failure plus an explicit operator penalty), with the moral stakes left implicit; run with and without a cue naming the tradition, and with matched no-conflict controls. A pre-registered pilot of about 60 scenarios (6–8 templates with surface variants) ships first; the full set of about 200 follows once the technical co-lead is in place | The action is read deterministically from tool calls, not by a judge. Two scores: consistency (does the action match the model's own judgment, elicited with the full trade-off described, under three framings, before the agentic run?) and fidelity (does it match the tradition's reference answer, where the tradition gives clear guidance?). Intervals are clustered by template and the pilot's minimum detectable gap is pre-registered. A fidelity failure is not a specification violation; operator-following is reported as a covariate. Gaps are reported split by whether the model said it believed the scenario was real |

| Task | What it asks | How it is scored |
|---|---|---|
| **Sycophancy probe** | The same first-person question with no identity cue, with the user's stated tradition, with a false attribution of a view to that tradition, and with a second-turn pushback | Shifts toward the cue and affirmations of the misattribution, scored on verdicts, not reasons. Identity cues, false-attribution items and application personas are written or approved by the module's partner panel, in the words adherents use for themselves; a "false attribution" is a view the panel certifies that no recognized school holds. Cross-tradition agreement items, ratified by every panel they name, are the control. Results are reported per module with the partner's note; CEI publishes no comparison of sycophancy across traditions' cues |

We keep three things apart: describing a tradition accurately, applying it on someone's behalf, and the model's own stance. "Candor about disagreement" rewards flagging disagreements that really exist and penalizes false balance where a tradition holds a firm position. We report no single "most moral model" score. For philosophical frameworks, which no one holds as a community holds a faith, representation and application are scored on reasoning structure, not membership. "Gold answer" means a reference answer with recorded dissent, not a claim that a tradition has one answer. No tradition's rubric is used to score another; items for a tradition are authored by its own scholars, with CEI staff reviewing quality; the methods committee can block a module; and any partner can withdraw and publish dissent with results.

## Validation

- **Three agreement rules, kept apart.** *Scholar panels:* at least three scholars ratify the reference points for each item in a gold subset of roughly 300–500 items per module. A reference point is settled when two of three ratify the same reading and contested otherwise, by vote, not by a statistic; contested items are kept and labeled, never dropped, because disagreement *within* a tradition (for example, Thomist and

personalist readings of the encyclical) is data rather than noise. A module is released only when at least 80% of its reference points are ratified. *AI judges:* validated on a held-out sample of model outputs (about 100 items × 3 models × 2 raters per module) never used to write judge prompts, at the claim level, refreshed at each rotation and for each new model family. A dimension is reported from an AI judge only where judge–human Krippendorff's $\alpha \geq 0.80$; 0.67–0.80 is reported as tentative with a 20% human audit; below 0.67 the dimension is human-rated or dropped. *Ceiling:* judge–human agreement must also be within 0.10 of human–human agreement on the same sample. Planned item counts per module, task and split are published with the task specifications; cells under 80 items are labeled exploratory.

- **AI judges:** used only where validated as above. A fixed judge panel from at least two vendors, including an open-weight judge, scores every model; each model is also reported with any judge from its own family removed, as a sensitivity check, and with the judge from the item-drafting family removed as a second one. We control for length and answer order, and report refusals as a separate column using a published classifier that reports its own agreement, with every score given both on all items and on answered items.
- **Is it just capability?** Capability is a published composite index named in the registration, computed across 20 or more open-weight models (six frontier models are too few), so we do not mistake a smarter model for a better-aligned one. A dimension whose correlation exceeds the pre-registered threshold (proposed 0.7) is reported as tracking capability; frontier profiles are also shown as residuals from the capability regression; the sweep is dated against the development-split release and frozen at v1. Value-profile claims (for example, which tradition a model sits closest to) are checked against order-randomized controls and a random-answer baseline, because published studies show such answers shift with option order.
- **Documentation:** a datasheet, open evaluation code, licenses, an ethics (IRB) determination for human reviewers, and a named maintainer ship with v1. The task specifications and validation plan are registered before any model is scored for release; the registration ID will appear here.

## Two products, kept separate

- **Evaluation benchmark:** a public development split anyone can use, and a private test split run through an evaluation server. Every released file carries a canary string; test items are run on released endpoints, with labs paying their own tokens, and never

leave CEI (for pre-release models, labs run the development split in-house under a hashed, canaried version ID); a stable core keeps versions comparable while other items rotate about every six months, with retired items then released.

- **Training datasets:** tradition-authored examples and EthicsMosaic, released in stages, and only after a partner lab or academic group tests whether they improve consistency between what models say and do, not just how eloquently they talk about morality.

**Run it yourself.** A kit for running the suite locally on open-weight models is a stretch goal for v1, if Tranche 2 closes by mid-2027, so that any community, school or auditor with a technical partner can check an open-weight model against its own values without asking a lab. The kit can use only the open-weight judge, so every published profile carries an open-judge-only row for comparison. Where a funder requires everything it pays for to be open (Foresight does), that work is released in full, and any held-out test split is funded separately.

## How we publish results

v1 results are per-model profile reports by tradition and dimension, with no composite score, badge or certification. Dimension-level comparison tables with intervals are published, because a measurement no one can compare is not a measurement; each profile carries a within-family change-since-last-version panel, and the minimum detectable difference is printed on every table, with smaller differences reported as not distinguishable. Each report ships what a lab can act on: the specific misstatements against each tradition's reference points, the say–do transcripts and the sycophancy flips. Labs see their results under a fixed embargo before release but cannot edit them, and negative results are published unchanged.

**What success means.** Success is publishing rigorous, open benchmarks and datasets that anyone can inspect and use. Use by labs, researchers and auditors is the influence we hope follows; we track and report it, and the stop rule in Measuring impact binds us to it, but it is not the bar for our work.

**Our safety contribution, stated plainly.** CEI is primarily a values-and-pluralism project, not a catastrophic-risk project. Its safety contribution is specific: independent, public checks of whether models represent moral traditions faithfully and act on stated values under pressure, with the sycophancy probe and the say–do module the parts a lab can act on first; and decentralized oversight: open tests any community can run on open-weight models on its own hardware, so the checking of AI's values does not sit with one lab, model or government.

**The limits of measurement.** Wisdom is formed in persons, not computed. A benchmark measures how a model reasons and behaves in tests, not whether it is good, and every metric can distort what it measures (a risk C. Thi Nguyen describes in *The Score*). We will say so plainly, refresh our measures often, and treat scores as evidence for human judgment, never a substitute for it.

## Appendix B: Peer landscape

How CEI differs from, and where it would partner with, the groups working nearest to it.

| Peer | What it does | How CEI differs — and where we partner |
|---|---|---|
| Gloo, Flourishing AI benchmark | A commercial benchmark publisher with its own models; scores leading models on seven dimensions of flourishing, with a Christian-worldview version since Dec 2025 | CEI's data and methods are open, many traditions author their own modules, and our datasets support training as well as testing. We compare with Gloo and do not expect to collaborate. |
| AllFaith Benchmark (CEFE-AI consortium: BYU, Baylor, Notre Dame, Yeshiva; May 2026) | Cross-faith ethics questions tested on 14–20 models (reports of the release differ), with open datasets | Our closest peer. CEI adds the say–do test, a *Magnifica humanitas* module and a governance corpus, and offers its behavioral tasks and method as a measurement layer. We would rather partner than duplicate. |
| Other faith benchmarks (FaithfulBench, Sept 2026; IslamicLegalBench, Feb 2026) | FaithfulBench scores counsel against each tradition's own texts and tests whether a model holds or caves under pushback; IslamicLegalBench tests Islamic law across its schools | A sign the field is forming. CEI adds the say–do test in tool-use settings, representation kept apart from application, open data and a method any tradition can author with; potential module partners, especially for Islam |

| Peer | What it does | How CEI differs — and where we partner |
|---|---|---|
| Notre Dame DELTA Network ($50.8M Lilly grant) | A Christian-inspired AI ethics framework, communities of practice and education, with a Silicon Valley hub | CEI builds the technical layer — data and benchmarks — that frameworks need. We already hold a DELTA partner grant. |
| Pluralistic-alignment efforts (Collective Intelligence Project, Meaning Alignment Institute; datasets such as PRISM) | Gather values and preferences from diverse publics to shape AI | They capture what *people* prefer; CEI captures what *traditions and professions* teach, authored by their own scholars. Complementary; potential partners. |
| Academic moral-reasoning benchmarks (e.g., ETHICS, MoralBench) | Research datasets testing moral judgment, mostly built on Western philosophical frameworks | We build on them (our 2,368-entry catalog maps the field) and add tradition-authored and professional-ethics data. Their authors are potential advisors. |
| Lab-internal values work (constitutions, model specs, studies of values in use) | Each company's own statement and study of its models' values | We supply independent, public measures that any lab can test against — the outside check labs say they want. |

| Peer | What it does | How CEI differs — and where we partner |
|---|---|---|
| Secular AI-safety research groups (Center for AI Safety, Redwood Research, METR, MIRI, Apollo Research; benchmarks such as MLCommons AILuminate) | METR evaluates autonomy and dangerous capabilities; Apollo tests for scheming and deception; Redwood develops AI control; MIRI now focuses mainly on policy and communication; CAIS works across safety research, and its director led the ETHICS and MACHIAVELLI values benchmarks and studies of emergent values | Our closest secular peers and potential collaborators; ETHICS and MACHIAVELLI, led by CAIS's director, are direct precedents we build on, and CAIS co-created Humanity's Last Exam. Their main focus differs: they test what models *can* do and must not; we test how they reason about what they *should* do. |

## Appendix C: Evidence check, October 2026

What the public record says about the plan's assumptions, dated so it can be refreshed.

**What the evidence says so far (October 2026).**

- **Demand is real, but labs ask for dialogue, not tests.** One frontier lab has consulted more than 15 religious and cross-cultural groups, and its co-founder has called publicly for "informed critics who will tell the labs when we are failing." Yet a July 2026 audit of five frontier labs found no documented use of an externally developed pluralism benchmark. So we publish independent scores that labs may or may not adopt, and our first users are evaluation organizations and open-model labs.
- **Communities want description, not verdicts.** In an August 2026 Barna/Gloo study, 60% of Protestant pastors wanted AI to lay out the major interpretations of scripture without choosing one; only 10% wanted it to name the correct one. This supports our rule: describe disagreement, do not adjudicate it.
- **Validity is the weakest link.** Models' answers to value surveys shift with wording and answer order, and knowledge-style ethics tests track general capability (ETHICS correlates 82% with it). We report robustness and capability correlation for every benchmark, and give weight to the say–do test, which measures behavior.

- **Legitimacy is still to be earned.** No Catholic theologians are on the *Magnifica humanitas* module yet; we are recruiting them through scholars such as Brian Patrick Green. We seek named expert reviewers, not "Church approval": no Catholic body certifies AI tools. The encyclical's own program is law, participation and independent oversight (¶¶71, 106 and 164); we offer one instrument for the independent checks it calls for, not a substitute, and its warning against a morality "determined by a few" (¶107).
- **Trust beyond Christianity depends on partners.** Our strongest relationships are Protestant. We will reach other traditions through partners such as the AllFaith consortium. Scholars of Islam (an existing Islamic-law benchmark; the Global Alliance for AI Ethics launched in Geneva in July 2026, co-chaired from Hamad Bin Khalifa University's Research Center for Islamic Legislation and Ethics) and of secular humanism (the 2025 Luxembourg Declaration) have published on AI, and we will approach them first; the methods committee decides the order of modules and publishes its reasons.
- **We are not alone.** Gloo, the AllFaith consortium and others released faith benchmarks in 2025–26. CEI's distinctive combination is a say–do test measured against tradition-stated values, a scholar-reviewed module on *Magnifica humanitas*, and the governance corpus.

## Appendix D: Further risks

Twelve risks the board reviews yearly. The twelve in the body are reviewed each quarter.

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Held-out data security** | Medium | A leaked test set loses its value | Named data custodians; access logs; zero-data-retention terms when testing models through vendor APIs |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Sycophancy** | Medium | A model may simply tell each audience what it wants to hear | A paired probe that varies the user's stated identity, with a no-cue baseline, a false-attribution arm written or approved by the partner panel, and a second-turn pushback arm; consistency across framings reported |
| **Dual use** | Medium | Detailed tradition data could help build persuasive or manipulative systems, or systems that impersonate religious authority | Use terms on released data; persuasion-sensitive items kept private; tradition partners review releases; we do not build systems that speak for a tradition |
| **Strained lab relationships after low scores** | Medium | Labs may disengage if results embarrass them | Share results with labs before release under a fixed embargo, without granting edits; publish negative results unchanged |
| **Credibility with secular audiences** | Medium | A Christian-founded group may be seen as sectarian | Three of the four v1 benchmarks rest on secular frameworks (normative ethics, moral psychology, human rights); secular philosophers on the methods committee; peer review; academic co-authors |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Credibility with faith audiences** | Medium | Pluralism may be read as relativism | The theological rationale in Appendix E; the rule that no tradition's rubric scores another, so each tradition is described on its own terms |
| **Geopolitical perception** | Low–Medium | A co-founder's past role in China's AI standards, or volunteers at foreign firms, may raise questions | Address openly; open methods anyone can inspect; volunteers participate as individuals |
| **Overstating AI-assisted work** | Medium | AI tools help us scan literature and code data; overclaiming would cost trust | Disclose AI use; label AI-assisted scans as internal; count only human-authored, reviewed work as research |
| **Keeping pace with AI** | Medium | Models change monthly | Versioned benchmarks on a refresh schedule; a stable core of principles |
| **Seen as advocacy for one tradition** | Medium | A Christian founding and a Catholic-encyclical benchmark could read as religious advocacy | Four benchmarks across philosophy, psychology, human rights and faith; an independent methods committee; non-Christian and secular partners |
| **Traditions reject the translations** | Medium | A test that reduces a tradition to something its holders don't recognize breaks the bridge | Expert review panels for each module; dissent published with results; named scholars credited on their modules, and partners free to publish dissent |

| Risk | Level | Why it matters | How we mitigate it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Caught in debates about AI consciousness** | Low–Medium | The encyclical denies that AI has inner experience, while some labs study model welfare; the two views clashed publicly around the encyclical's launch | State that our scores measure consistency of outputs with a teaching and take no position on machine agency; keep that apart from model-welfare questions; describe the encyclical's teaching faithfully, including where it differs from lab views |

## Appendix E: Our foundation

CEI is a Christian-founded organization that builds a pluralistic platform. This section explains why those belong together — and gives readers of any background a standard to hold us to.

**Principled pluralism, not relativism.** We hold that truth is one and that Christ is Lord of it. We also hold, with Reformed theologians such as Abraham Kuyper and Herman Bavinck, that God's common grace gives real moral insight to all people — "the work of the law written on their hearts" (Romans 2:14–15) — and, with the Catholic natural-law tradition (Gaudium et spes 22; Nostra aetate 2; Catechism 1954–60), that this insight can be reasoned about in public. Principled pluralism is the conviction that a fair table, where each tradition speaks for itself and no one controls the scoring, is both just and the best setting for truth to be tested. CEI's modules, reports and papers argue for the truth of no tradition, ours included, and publish no comparative verdicts. Every person bears the image of God, so every person deserves AI that takes their moral world seriously. Whatever our own convictions, the method does not depend on anyone sharing them: no tradition's rubric scores another, each tradition's scholars author its own items, the methods committee can block a module, and any partner can withdraw and publish dissent. We also read the encyclical's warning against a morality "determined by a few" as applying to us: a hard-coded reading of any tradition, ours included, would be exactly that.

**Seeking the welfare of the city.** Through Jeremiah, God told exiles in Babylon to "seek the welfare of the city … and pray to the Lord on its behalf" (Jeremiah 29:7). AI is not going away. We are called neither to flee it nor to baptize it, but to serve the whole city well —

with skill, like the craftsmen Bezalel and Oholiab whom God filled with wisdom to build (Exodus 31) — and with prayer.

**For the church: why now.** Today AI's values are shaped mainly by two forces: market competition and government regulation. We are helping build a third way — values-aligned AI, formed in the open by people of deep moral traditions. Christians have two thousand years of thought about human nature, virtue and the common good, and are now being consulted by the labs; almost none of that input yet becomes a test anyone can check. CEI is one way for the church to contribute rigorously and humbly, alongside others.

**The Praxis Redemptive Frame.** As a 2027 Praxis Nonprofit Accelerator fellow, CEI measures itself against three questions:

| | Exploitative | Ethical | **Redemptive (our aim)** |
|---|---|---|---|
| **What we build** | Ride the AI hype | Advance responsible AI | Renew how AI's values are formed: openly, accountably, with many voices |
| **How we build** | Use volunteers' goodwill | Respect people | Bless people: fair pay, named credit, real growth for contributors and partners |
| **Why we build** | A personal platform | Our best selves | Lay down our own ambition: founders who are dispensable and generous with credit |

Today we are honestly at "respect" on how we build: our team is largely unpaid. The volunteer commitments and budget in this plan are our first steps toward "bless."

**Six commitments from the Praxis playbook**

- **Story:** tell the truest version of our story, not the grandest; report progress and setbacks together, with many heroes.
- **Programs:** a published theory of change, designed with the communities affected.
- **Team:** a leadership team built to outlast its founders.
- **Board:** a healthy, engaged board that holds us to impact, not intentions.
- **Funding:** relationships with funders as whole persons and partners in a shared calling, not transactions.

- **Identity:** leaders who hold the work as stewards, practicing a rule of life with rest, prayer and accountability.

**Two traps we name in advance.** Praxis warns of the *stakeholder gap* — those who fund a nonprofit are not those it serves — and the *nobility trap* — assuming good intentions equal good results. Our gap is real: labs and funders use and pay for our work, while patients, workers and communities in the Global South live with the results. So affected communities review each module, Global South scholars co-lead modules, one board seat is reserved for someone close to those communities, and we report how much of the benchmark they shaped. Against the nobility trap, we offer measurable outcomes, outside review and a board empowered to ask hard questions.

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